PROJECT REPORT

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Branch: Computer Science and Engineering

Year: 2025–2026

Course Code: CSE0001

Course Title: Digital Literacy

Date: 31/03/2026

1. Introduction

This project was undertaken in my role as a Student Digital Ambassador, with the objective of promoting digital awareness and responsible online behavior among my peers. In today's environment, where most academic and social interactions take place online, digital literacy is not just a skill but a necessity.

The project is structured across five modules, each addressing a key aspect of digital literacy, including awareness, professional presence, communication, and cyber safety. Through these tasks, I worked on creating practical resources such as an infographic, professional profiles, email drafts, and safety guidelines that can help students navigate the digital space more effectively.

This experience allowed me to not only develop my own understanding but also think from the perspective of guiding others, which is an essential responsibility of a Digital Ambassador.

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2. Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Tool Used: Canva

Description: The infographic titled *"Digital Skills for Students"* covers key aspects of digital literacy, including what digital literacy means, safe internet practices, useful digital tools for students, and building a professional online presence. It is designed using a clear, section-based layout that presents concise and practical information, making it easy for students to understand and apply in their daily digital activities.

Reflection: I found the design process in Canva engaging because of its flexibility and ease of use. While creating the infographic, I realized the importance of keeping the content simple and well-structured rather than overcrowding it with information. Balancing visual appeal with clarity required careful selection of points and proper spacing. This task helped me understand that effective communication, especially in a visual format, depends not only on what is presented but also on how it is presented.

3.Task 2: Student Digital Portfolio

Platforms Set Up: GitHub and LinkedIn

Purpose: These platforms serve as my professional digital presence. GitHub is used to host and organize my project work, allowing me to showcase my progress and technical skills. LinkedIn helps me present my academic background, connect with peers and professionals, and stay updated with opportunities in the field of technology.

Future Plans: Over the next four years, I plan to consistently use GitHub to upload academic and personal projects, especially in programming and machine learning. On LinkedIn, I aim to build a strong professional network, connect with industry professionals, and explore internship opportunities while staying informed about trends in the tech industry**.**

4.Task 3: Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Platforms Used: HackerRank and Google Forms

Practiced/Built: I completed a beginner-level coding challenge on HackerRank to strengthen my understanding of basic programming and logical thinking. In addition, I created a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms, consisting of five questions including both multiple-choice and short-answer types. The form was linked to a response sheet to collect and analyze answers efficiently.

Academic Help: These platforms play an important role in my academic journey as a Computer Science student. HackerRank helps in improving problem-solving skills and preparing for technical assessments, while Google Forms is useful for creating surveys, quizzes, and collecting data for academic projects.

5. Task 4: Email Etiquette & Communication

Reflection on Communication Failure:

Consider a hypothetical scenario where a student sends an email to a professor stating only:
"Need extension for assignment." without including a subject line, proper greeting, or their name and registration number. The professor, handling multiple students and assignments, is unable to identify the sender or understand the context of the request. As a result, the email is either ignored or overlooked, and the student misses the deadline, leading to a loss of marks.

This situation could have been avoided by following basic email etiquette. A clear subject line such as *"Extension Request: Assignment 2 – Reg No 25BCE11186"*, along with a formal greeting and a structured message, would provide the necessary context. Including identification details ensures that the recipient can respond appropriately. This highlights the importance of clarity, structure, and professionalism in digital communication.

6. Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness (UPI / Online Payment Fraud)

Reflection:

While researching UPI/Online Payment Fraud, I was surprised by how easily users can be tricked into authorizing payments. Many fraud cases occur because individuals are unaware that entering a UPI PIN is only required when sending money, not receiving it. Fraudsters often create urgency or pose as trusted sources, leading victims to approve payment requests or click malicious links.

What stood out most was that students and young users are especially vulnerable due to frequent use of digital payment apps and lack of awareness about such scams. The simplicity of these attacks makes them particularly dangerous, as they rely more on manipulation than technical complexity.

Habit Change:

As a result, I will be more cautious while handling digital transactions. I will avoid approving unknown payment requests, never share my UPI PIN or OTP, and always verify the source before taking any action. I will also stay informed about common fraud techniques and encourage others to follow safe digital practices.

7. Conclusion

This project has shown me that digital literacy goes beyond simply using technology; it is closely linked to identity, awareness, and online safety. From creating a structured GitHub portfolio to understanding real-world threats like UPI/online payment fraud, I now feel more prepared to guide my peers as a Student Digital Ambassador.

Each task contributed to building practical skills, whether it was designing an informative infographic, setting up professional profiles, or practicing effective communication through emails. At the same time, exploring cybercrime made me more aware of how easily individuals can be targeted due to lack of knowledge.

The most important takeaway is that our digital footprint is permanent, and maintaining it requires consistent awareness, responsible behavior, and professional discipline.

References

- Canva (Design Tool): canva.com
- National Cyber Crime Portal: cybercrime.gov.in
- Google Forms: forms.google.com
- GitHub: github.com
- LinkedIn: linkedin.com